

Kitchen Cleaning SOP

The Cleaning CEO Blueprint — 100% Cleaner Academy

Applies to: Regular (\$150), Deep (\$300), Move-Out, and Airbnb turnovers

Time target: Regular 25–30 min | Deep 45–60 min | Move-out 90–120 min

Purpose

The kitchen is the highest-risk area for cross-contamination and the most scrutinized room by clients. Follow color-coding and work **clean to dirty, top to bottom**.

Supplies

- ☐ All-purpose cleaner (pH-neutral)
- ☐ Degreaser (deep/move-out)
- ☐ Glass cleaner
- ☐ Microfiber cloths — **RED for kitchen only**
- ☐ Scrub pad (non-scratch)
- ☐ Stainless steel cleaner (if applicable)
- ☐ Disinfectant for sink and food-prep surfaces
- ☐ Trash bags
- ☐ Gloves

Separate from bathroom supplies at all times.

Cross-Contamination Rules

Rule	Why
Red cloths = kitchen only	Prevents bathroom bacteria on food surfaces
Clean sink last (before final wipe)	Sink collects runoff from dirty tasks
Never set toilet brush or bath cloths on counters	Obvious but happens when rushing

Use separate trash bag for raw meat packaging if found	Dispose immediately, wash hands
Disinfect cutting board areas if visible	Client food prep surface
Rinse cloths between zones: counters → appliances → sink	Don't spread grease backward

Kitchen Order of Operations

Work **top to bottom, dry before wet, back of counters forward**.

Phase 1 — Upper Area (Dry)

- ☐ Remove items blocking surfaces (don't reorganize — group and replace)
- ☐ Dust/wipe top of fridge and cabinet tops (if reachable and in scope)
- ☐ Wipe cabinet fronts and handles
- ☐ Clean microwave interior, then exterior
- ☐ Wipe small appliances (toaster, coffee maker exterior)
- ☐ Wipe backsplash

Phase 2 — Countertops & Stovetop

- ☐ Clear crumbs and debris into trash (not sink)
- ☐ Apply degreaser to stovetop if deep clean — dwell 3–5 min
- ☐ Wipe counters back-to-front with clean microfiber
- ☐ Scrub stovetop, burners/grates (remove only if you know how to reinstall)
- ☐ Wipe range hood exterior and filter cover
- ☐ Clean control panels with slightly damp cloth only — no soaking

Phase 3 — Sink & Faucet (Disinfect Last)

- ☐ Remove dishes **only if in scope** (dishes add-on +\$25)
- ☐ Rinse sink basin
- ☐ Apply disinfectant; scrub basin, faucet, handles, and drain area
- ☐ Polish faucet dry for shine
- ☐ Wipe surrounding counter one final time

Phase 4 — Lower Area & Floor

- ☐ Wipe lower cabinet fronts and drawer pulls

- ☐ Wipe dishwasher exterior and handle
- ☐ Clean fridge exterior — handles, front, sides if accessible
- ☐ Sweep kitchen floor
- ☐ Mop last (see Floor SOP)

Appliance Scope by Service Type

Task	Regular	Deep	Move-Out
Wipe appliance exteriors	✓	✓	✓
Clean microwave inside	✓	✓	✓
Degrease range hood	✗	✓	✓
Inside oven	Add-on +\$40	Add-on	✓ Included
Inside refrigerator	Add-on +\$35	Add-on	✓ Included
Inside dishwasher	✗	Wipe door/edges	Full detail
Pull appliances forward	✗	✗	✓ If accessible

Stovetop Technique

- ☐ Remove loose grates/knobs only if trained
- ☐ Scrape burnt residue with plastic scraper (not metal on glass tops)
- ☐ Degrease, dwell, scrub with non-scratch pad
- ☐ Wipe dry — streak-free on glass cooktops
- ☐ Replace grates aligned properly

Glass cooktop: Use cooktop-specific cleaner only. No abrasive powder.

Stainless Steel

- ☐ Wipe **with the grain**
- ☐ Use stainless cleaner or diluted dish soap — never pure bleach
- ☐ Dry immediately to prevent water spots
- ☐ Handles and fridge front are review points — don't skip

Quality Standards

Kitchen passes when:

- ☐ Counters are clear, crumb-free, and not greasy to the touch
- ☐ Sink shines and smells neutral
- ☐ Stovetop has no visible splatter or burnt-on spots (deep/move-out)
- ☐ Appliance exteriors are fingerprint-free
- ☐ Floor is swept and mopped — check under kitchen mat
- ☐ No cross-contamination cloths left on food surfaces

Do NOT (Kitchen)

- ☒ Use the same cloth on floor then counter
- ☒ Mix bleach with any other product
- ☒ Soak control panels or electrical outlets
- ☒ Use steel wool on any kitchen surface
- ☒ Pour grease down client drains
- ☒ Open client food containers or eat client food
- ☒ Move knife blocks or heavy appliances alone
- ☒ Use bathroom disinfectant on food prep surfaces without rinsing (check product label)

Common Client Requests (Add-Ons)

- **Dishes (+\$25):** Wash, dry, put away — confirm dishwasher vs hand-wash preference
- **Inside oven (+\$40):** Cold oven, degreaser, racks soaked in sink
- **Inside fridge (+\$35):** Remove expired items to trash with client permission only

100% Cleaner — A clean kitchen sells your recurring contract.